



MONTHLY UPDATE

North Africa: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-02 · 3 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · INSTITUTIONS AND MANDATES · SHARED SYSTEMS AND INFRASTRUCTURE

Summary of the month

North Africa's AI diplomacy moved through the Arab League rather than the AU this month: the [Arab ICT Ministers Council's Executive Bureau confirmed the six working-group chairs of its new AI governance and digital committee on 1 August, with Egypt, Libya and Tunisia among them](#), a bloc-level track running alongside the continental one. A separate Arab conference [closed in Tunis on 20 August recommending member states expand digital identity and strengthen data protection in civil-status registers](#). On the infrastructure side, Ookla's [year-one retrospective on the region's 5G launches found the combined 4G+5G experience below its pre-launch baseline in Egypt, Morocco and Tunisia, with Algeria – the newest of the four markets – the only one to improve](#).

Institutions and mandates

Regional collaboration

The Arab League's new AI governance and digital committee has its working groups staffed. The [58th ordinary session of the AICTM Executive Bureau confirmed the full slate of six working-group chairs on 1 August](#), three of them African: Egypt chairs AI Governance and Quantum Computing, Libya chairs AI Data and Digital Infrastructure, and Tunisia chairs AI Innovation. [Egypt's own chairmanship was reported a day earlier](#), the AI Governance group's remit stated as including activation of the 2025 Arab Charter for AI Ethics. No framework text, timetable or output has been published from any of the six groups.

[A conference of Arab nationality and civil-status directors closed in Tunis on 20 August](#) recommending that member states expand reliance on digital identity, strengthen the legal frameworks protecting personal data in civil-status registers, and share defences against cyber threats aimed at those registers. A model data-protection framework for such registers is to be circulated, and Iraq's proposal for a unified Arab identity was referred to member states for study. The outputs are recommendations only, with no adoption route, timetable or governance body named.

Shared systems and infrastructure

Connectivity

A year after North Africa's first 5G launches, three of the four markets deliver a worse aggregate mobile experience than before them. Ookla's [one-year-on retrospective, published 3 August](#), found the combined 4G+5G median below the pre-launch baseline in Egypt, Morocco and Tunisia, with 4G itself down 28% in Morocco and Tunisia; Algeria

alone improved. Ookla names regulatory design — coverage mandates, licence terms and fixed-wireless speed floors, which differ across all four markets — as the likely variable. Algeria's own 5G licences were awarded only in December 2025, so its market is the newest of the four and not yet reflected in a full year of data.

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